

on life. In the meantime, consider this a blessing. We all need a little help sometimes, in one form or another.”

“Right now, we can use all the help we can get.”

“By the way, why don’t you and Naomi visit our church sometime? In fact, I’d be glad to have you in my Sunday school class for young couples.”

“Maybe we’ll do that,” Ben replied as they got up to leave. “Thanks for your help.”



“Mr. and Mrs. Wister, your petition for bankruptcy protection in accordance with Chapter 13 of the Federal Bankruptcy Code is approved,” Judge Martinez said. “There are conditions associated with this action, and one of them is that you must remain current on the repayment plan established by this court. Do you understand this clearly?”

“Yes, ma’am, we do,” replied Ben.

“The bankruptcy court is provided to give people who have had personal financial setbacks beyond their control the chance to start over again.

“I hope you have learned from your bad experiences with the overuse of credit and that you will not repeat the same mistakes. You’re young and can reestablish your lives and your credit if you discipline yourselves.”

Naomi sat in stunned silence as she came to grips with the reality of her situation. She felt horrible that the judge was chastening them in public for their overuse of credit. She was nearly in tears with shame as the courtroom cleared and just wanted to go home where she could weep in privacy.

“What’s the matter?” Ben asked as he and the attorney approached her.

“I’m so embarrassed by this. We never should have charged so much. Our creditors must think we’re awful people.”